

can list multiple locations. Usually, there are two types of locations. One is directly under the project file. The other is under each app directory.

Assuming `STATIC_URL = 'static/'`, when an HTTP request with `/static/` comes, the development server handles the static files located in the static directories specified by `STATICFILES_DIRS`.

Production Stage

When `DEBUG` is switched to `False`, Django considers that the app is running under the production environment and lets the **web server** (or reverse proxy server) handle the static files stored in the specified location set by `STATIC_ROOT`.

Assuming `STATIC_URL = 'static/'` is written in the `settings.py` file, when an HTTP request with `/static/` comes, the web server handles the static files located in the `static` directory specified by `STATIC_ROOT`.

collectstatic

The `collectstatic` command collects all static files located in several places and puts them in the directory specified by `STATIC_ROOT`.

If you don't do this, your web application UI will be broken.

This is an example of the Django admin page when you forget to run the `collectstatic` command. We'll demonstrate the command in the next section.